

**I moved 14
miles closer
and lost 20
minutes.**

What's inside

- **The 14 mile trap**
- **Rate, not price**
- **Boundaries beat district names**
- **Two weeks a year**
- **Your real weekend radius**

The 14 Mile Trap

I cut 14 miles off my Austin drive and it cost me 20 minutes each way.

The new route crossed a highway that stacks up at 7:40 and never recovers.

In Texas you commute the chokepoints, not the mileage.

The cheaper address costs more.

Rate, Not Price

No state income tax gets all the attention. The property tax rate is the part that actually moves.

Two nearly identical houses, opposite sides of one line, and the annual bills are thousands apart.

People shop list price and never pull the rate.

That line does something worse.

Districts Lie, Boundaries Don't

Especially around DFW. One district name covers campuses that look nothing alike.

And boundaries get redrawn when a few hundred new roofs go up.

Buy the attendance zone. Not the logo on the water tower.

None of it survives February.

Two Weeks Run The Year

Fifty weeks here are genuinely great.
Two of them decide how you feel
about the house.

One stretch of triple digits and one
freeze week where pipes and power
get tested.

Ask about shade orientation, attic
work, and how the place handled the
last freeze.

The map gets smaller fast.

The 90 Minute Circle

Every transplant says they will drive anywhere. By month three, weekends live inside 90 minutes.

San Antonio buys you Hill Country and a shot at the coast. Austin buys you rivers and lakes close in. DFW weekends run toward water east and quiet south.

Pick the city whose 90 minute circle you actually want.

Almost nobody picks right first.

Your call

**Shorter commute
or lower tax rate?**

Save this for later.